

Word Family Cricket — Teacher Guide

Age group Grade 1–5	Class size Any	Time 15–30 min	Materials None
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Overview

Word Family Cricket uses the sport every Karnataka kid already knows to make word families competitive and fun. Students take turns batting by naming words from a called family — the longer their streak, the more runs they score, just like cricket.

Setup

- No materials needed — this is a speaking game
- Works with any class size — individual vs individual
- Teacher acts as the bowler (can also be a confident student)
- Choose which word families to use before the session — match to what students have recently learned

How to Play

1. **Bowler calls a word family:**
Say: "-at family — go!" or "-og family — go!"
2. **Batsman responds with a valid word from that family:**
Example: "cat", "bat", "mat" for the -at family
3. Bowler immediately calls the same or a different family again
4. The rally continues — tracking consecutive correct answers for bonus runs
5. **The game ends when:**
 - (a) The batsman gets 3 misses — OUT, new game begins
 - (b) The batsman says 6 words correctly — batsman wins!

Scoring

Words in a row	Runs scored	Cricket equivalent
1 correct word	1 run	Single
2 in a row	4 runs	Boundary
3 in a row	6 runs	Six!
Miss (wrong/no answer)	0 + strike	Dot ball
3 misses	OUT	Wicket!

Example Rally

Teacher says	Student responds
'at' family — bat!	'at' family — cat! (1 run)
'at' family — go!	'at' family — mat! (4 runs — 2 in a row)
'og' family — go!	'og' family — dog! (6 runs — 3 in a row)
'og' family — go!	Silence... (Strike 1)

Volunteer Tips

- Keep the pace fast — hesitation for more than 3 seconds counts as a miss
- Celebrate loudly when a student hits a 4 or 6 — make it feel like a real match
- Start with easy families (-at, -in, -og) before introducing harder ones
- If a student says a non-word, gently correct and count as a miss
- Let confident students bowl against each other — you become the umpire
- Run a class tournament — track scores on the board over multiple sessions

Differentiation

For beginners:

Stick to one word family per game. Give students the word list in front of them — they read aloud rather than recall from memory.

For advanced students:

Mix families mid-rally — switch from -at to -og to -in without warning. Students must listen carefully and switch instantly.

Word Families Quick Reference

Family	Valid words
-at	bat, cat, fat, hat, mat, pat, rat, sat
-an	can, fan, man, pan, ran, van
-ot	cot, dot, got, hot, lot, not, pot, rot
-og	dog, fog, hog, jog, log
-oy	boy, joy, toy
-in	bin, fin, pin, tin, win
-ig	big, dig, fig, pig, wig
-ip	dip, hip, lip, rip, sip, tip, zip
-it	bit, fit, hit, kit, lit, pit, sit
-ox	box, fox, ox
-op	cop, hop, mop, pop, top

